



Nurturing regenerative food systems in a changing climate

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S16.3 - Short Value Chains for Vulnerable Urban Consumers: Linking Factory Workers with A Certified Vegetable Cooperative in Vietnam

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Abstract: The Nutrition Intervention Forecasting and Monitoring (NIFAM) project applies transdisciplinary decision analysis to support sustainable food environments and improve nutrition outcomes in Vietnam. Using structured decision framing, NIFAM identified a mobile safe vegetable point-of-sale on factory campuses as a promising intervention to improve food environments for vulnerable urban communities in Hanoi.

Our decision model demonstrates that direct connections between consumers and producers generate benefits for participating stakeholders, including enhanced awareness, improved health outcomes, strengthened social relationships, and positive environmental impacts. However, realizing these benefits involves both short-term and long-term costs. Various risk factors - such as extreme weather events and transportation delays - along with broader contextual conditions, were identified as influencing its overall effectiveness, both directly and indirectly. Moreover, several unforeseen factors emerged during the intervention's implementation and monitoring phases, affecting its outcomes, such as selling skills and facilitator.

Our results underscore the critical role of multiple stakeholder engagement in the establishment, operation, and sustainability of the intervention. Notably, the active involvement of Labour Union officials within the factory was instrumental in maintaining and expanding the model. The findings also highlight farmers' willingness to adapt to new roles as sellers, beyond their traditional roles as producers. Additionally, communication initiatives led by researchers effectively raised awareness among workers and promoted the consumption of safe vegetables.

The supply chain innovation demonstrated the feasibility of a novel business model that enhances access to safe vegetables for vulnerable urban consumers by creating a short value chain directly linking producers with factory workers in urban settings.